next to me, not sure what to say. A dark cloud hangs over me like the world has ended. Nobody could convince me otherwise.

Half an hour later, I still haven't said a word as I am called for the press conference with Mike Atherton, receiving the player of the series award. I'd bowled really well at Lord's and Headingley, taking 12 wickets in the series. Not that any of it mattered any more. I just feel the pure exhaustion of defeat, the humiliation of having not been able to see the team over the line and, at his first question, feel myself turning away, unable to answer, tears flooding my senses.